

Contoso Corp Code of Conduct and Business Ethics Policy

Purpose and Scope

This policy sets the standard of ethical conduct expected of every Contoso Corp employee, contractor, and officer in all business dealings, whether with customers, suppliers, competitors, or each other. It applies globally across every Contoso location and subsidiary.

Core Ethical Principles

Integrity in Business Dealings

Employees must never misrepresent Contoso's products, financial results, or capabilities to customers, investors, or regulators. Any employee who discovers a misstatement in a customer-facing or financial document must report it immediately through the channels described below.

Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose to their manager and to HR any outside financial interest, board seat, or family relationship that could reasonably influence, or appear to influence, a business decision they make on Contoso's behalf. Disclosure does not automatically bar the activity; it allows Contoso to assess and, if needed, put safeguards in place.

Gifts and Entertainment

Employees may accept or offer business gifts and entertainment of modest value (generally under \$100) when doing so is customary and does not create an appearance of impropriety. Cash gifts, and any gift offered with the expectation of a specific business decision in return, are never permitted.

Reporting Violations

Internal Reporting Channels

Concerns can be raised with your manager, with HR, or with the Ethics Office at ethics@contoso-corp.example. Reports may be made by name or, where local law permits, anonymously.

Non-Retaliation Commitment

Contoso prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports a good-faith concern or participates in an investigation. Reports of retaliation are treated as seriously as the underlying conduct being reported.

Consequences of Violations

Confirmed violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment, and in some cases referral to law enforcement or regulators. The severity of the response depends on the nature of the violation and whether it was disclosed voluntarily.